# HERALDRY SKIRMISH

## THE DYING LANDS

*A competitive GM-less PvPvE fantasy tabletop miniature skirmish game*

PRODUCTION SPECIMEN ? representative pages extracted from the RC485 build for design review. Not the finished book.

**Release Candidate 485 (RC485)**

## 2.1 Core Terms

A **combatant** is any Hero, Hireling, Monster, Summon, or other model that can act on the battlefield.

A **Hero** is a player-controlled adventurer and the primary member of a party.

A **Hireling** is an allied non-Hero combatant whose profile or granting rule identifies them as a Hireling. Hirelings follow the normal rules for combatants unless a rule says otherwise.

A **Monster** is a neutral or hostile non-party combatant controlled by the Monster AI rules.

A **Summon** is a temporary combatant that their creating rule identifies as a Summon. A combatant does not become a Summon merely because a rule places or creates them. In particular, a named bestiary Monster placed by a Monster or scenario rule remains a **Monster** unless that rule explicitly identifies them as a Summon.

A **living combatant** is any combatant that does not have the **Undead** or **Construct** ability.

A **Celestial** is a combatant whose rule gives them the **Celestial** tag. A **Fiend** is a combatant whose rule gives them the **Fiend** tag; the **Fiend** Special Ability grants this tag. Neither tag has an effect by itself; rules that affect Celestials or Fiends say so explicitly.

An **allied** combatant is on your side. An **ally** is another combatant on your side; you are not your own ally. A rule that can affect you says **you**, **yourself**, **self**, or **you or an ally**. An **enemy** combatant is any combatant not on your side, including opposing party combatants and Monsters, unless a rule says a specific combatant is not an enemy for that interaction.

A **party** is one side's allied Heroes and Hirelings. Allied Summons belong to their controlling party for party-wide limits, but are not Heroes, Hirelings, or Roster members.

A **Party Leader** is the Hero designated by a side to anchor that side's Initiative rolls and to make choices assigned to the **Party Leader** by these rules. Each side designates one **Party Leader** as described in **6.1**. A party does not replace its **Party Leader** during an adventure. If the **Party Leader** is not on the battlefield, use **3.2** for Initiative and **6.1** for shared-control authority.

A **target** is the combatant, marker, hazard, terrain feature, or point chosen by a rule or action.

A combatant, marker, hazard, terrain feature, or point is **adjacent** to another when the horizontal distance and vertical separation between the two are each **1"** or less. In **Grid Mode**, the two horizontal positions must overlap or neighbour each other orthogonally or diagonally, and the vertical separation between them must be **1"** or less.

A **space** is the area a combatant, marker, hazard, or terrain feature occupies. A combatant's space is their rules **footprint**, determined by **Sz** under the **Size and Footprints** rules in **2.6**. In **Grid Mode**, it is the square or squares that footprint occupies.

Unless a rule says otherwise, combatants are aware in all directions and do not use facing.

An **Area of Effect** is any blast, burst, cone, line, Aura, or similar effect that affects an area rather than one target.

An **Explosion** is an effect that specifically says it explodes. Do not treat every Area of Effect as an Explosion unless the rule says so.

A combatant, marker, hazard, terrain feature, or point is **visible** to you if you have **LOS** to it, it is not **Hidden** from you, and no other rule prevents you from seeing it.

## 2.6 Measurement, Size, Distances, and Rounding

You may measure any distance or check **LOS** at any time.

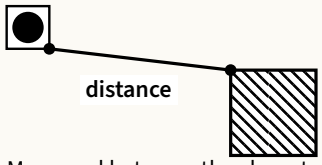
Heraldry Skirmish is played on a **36"×36"** battlefield unless a scenario says otherwise.

**Tabletop Mode:** Measure distances in inches between the closest points of the source and target spaces. If a rule measures from or to an origin point, target point, or other point, use that point.

**Grid Mode:** Use a **36"×36"** battle map marked in **1"** squares. A combatant occupies the squares listed by their **Sz** footprint. A marker, token, hazard, or terrain feature occupies every square whose centre lies under it, rounded outward at ties.

Each orthogonal square of movement or distance counts as **1"**, and each diagonal square counts as **1.5"**, unless a rule says otherwise. For range and other non-movement distances, count the shortest grid distance without counting the source square. Obstacles do not change this distance unless a rule says otherwise; check **LOS**, **Cover**, and terrain separately.

**A** **Tabletop Mode (2.6)**

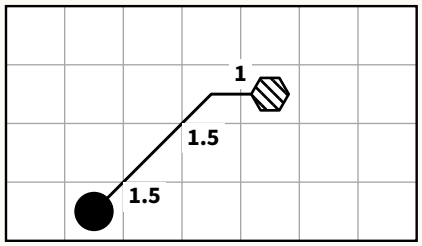



Measured between the closest points of the source and target spaces.

Rules footprints are used, not the miniature's base. Rules that measure from a point use that point.

**Schematic — not to scale**

**B** **Grid Mode: range / distance (2.6)**

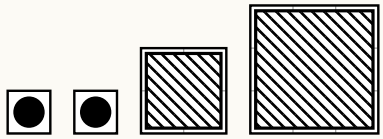



source square

**1.5" + 1.5" + 1" = 4"**

Orthogonal square = 1", diagonal square = 1.5". Count the shortest grid distance without the source square. Obstacles do not change it; check LOS, Cover and terrain separately.

**C** **Grid Mode: footprints (2.6)**




A combatant occupies the squares of their Sz footprint (S and M 1×1, L 2×2, H 3×3). Their whole footprint must fit in every legal final position.

**D** **Declared movement and positional state (2.6.1)**

**1 Declare**
Before voluntary or forced movement, declare the intended path and final position (for placement, the final position).

→

**2 Verify**
An opposing player may measure and verify it. If illegal, amend it or choose another action; an abandoned declaration costs no AP.

→

**3 Move**
Once movement begins, or a Reaction is declared against it, the declaration cannot be amended or abandoned. A triggered Reaction resolves at the first point on the path where its trigger occurs.

→

**4 Declared State**
The actual path and final position become the Declared State until the combatant moves or is moved. If a miniature is moved accidentally, restore it.

**FIG-04.** Tabletop Mode measures between closest points; Grid Mode counts orthogonal squares as 1" and diagonal squares as 1.5", so this range is 1.5 + 1.5 + 1 = 4" without the source square. Footprints follow Sz, and movement is declared and verified before it is resolved (see 2.6).

## 3.1 Overview of a Round

Unless a specific rule changes the order of the **Party Phase** and **Monster Phase**, each round is resolved in the following order:

**Initiative Phase**

- Refresh AP for each combatant on the battlefield with an AP maximum.
- Determine Initiative.
- Resolve start-of-round effects.

**Party Phase**

- Sides alternate activating eligible allied combatants.
- Heroes, Hirelings, and allied Summons act during this phase unless a rule says otherwise.
- Each allied combatant may activate **once per round** while they are eligible.

**Monster Phase**

- Resolve Monster waking rules.
- Activate each **Awake** Monster Group.

**End of Round**

- Resolve end-of-round effects.
- End effects that last **until the end of the round**.
- Remove unspent AP.
- Resolve scenario scoring, extraction, round limits, and victory conditions.

A new round begins after the previous round ends unless the scenario ends first.

If a specific rule places the **Monster Phase** before the **Party Phase**, both phases still resolve once before the **End of Round** begins.

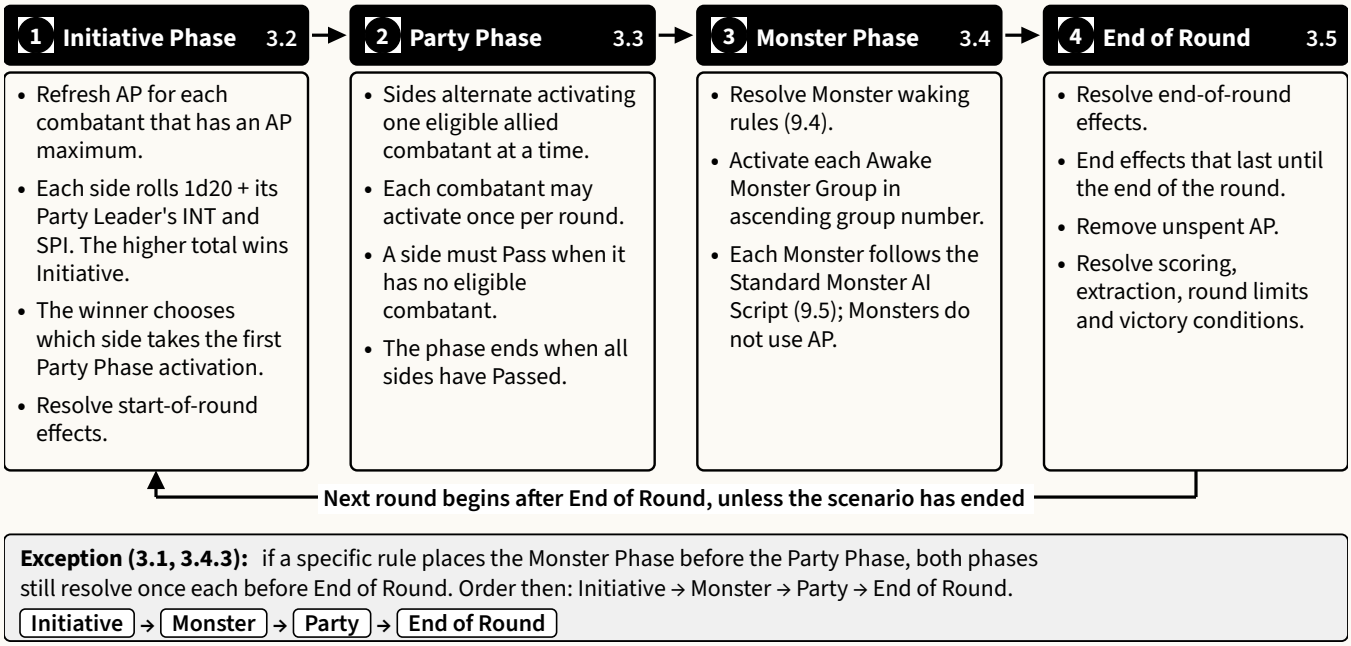


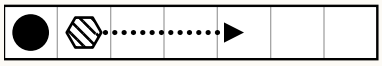

**FIG-01.** The four phases of a round in order. If a specific rule places the Monster Phase before the Party Phase, both phases still resolve once before End of Round (see 3.1).

If forced movement moves a target into hazardous terrain or another rule-defined danger, resolve that hazard after the forced movement ends.

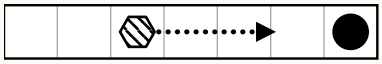
*Example: An effect pushes a Skeleton **3"** directly away from the effect's source, toward a ledge that lies **2"** along the forced movement path. The missing surface beyond the ledge does not stop the forced movement. The Skeleton moves **2"** to the edge point, the forced movement ends, and the Skeleton then resolves **Falling** from that point.*

**A** **Push, Pull, Slide (4.4.6)**

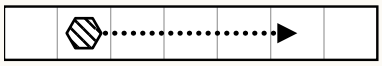
**Push X": directly away from the source**



**Pull X": directly toward the source**



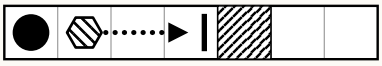
**Slide X": in the direction the effect names**



Forced movement never triggers Reflex Attack. Terrain movement costs count against the listed distance (4.4.7).

**B** **Collision (4.4.6)**

**Impassable Terrain in the path**

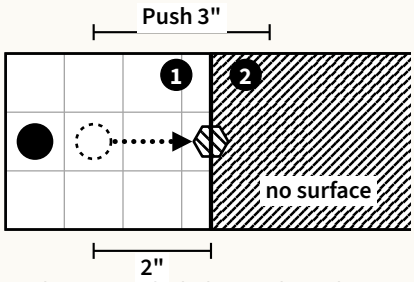


**Another combatant in the path**



The target stops at the last legal position and suffers a Collision. A Collision deals no damage by itself; a rule that deals Collision damage says so.

**C** **Ledge example (4.4.6)**




Push 3" toward a ledge 2" along the path (Skeleton). (1) The missing surface does not stop the push: the Skeleton moves 2" to the edge point and the forced movement ends. (2) Falling is then resolved from that point. This is not a Collision.

**Key** Pushing source · Target (Skeleton) · Another combatant · Impassable Terrain / missing surface · Forced movement · starting position

**FIG-09.** Forced movement follows a line and stops at the last legal position; a Collision deals no damage by itself. Source example: a 3" Push toward a ledge 2" away moves the Skeleton 2" to the edge point, then Falling is resolved from that point (see 4.4.6).

## 4.4.7 Terrain and Movement

Terrain types and tags are defined in **Section 2.9**. Apply terrain movement costs and hazards to **Move**, **Shift**, **Climb**, **Jump**, **Push**, **Pull**, and **Slide** unless a rule says otherwise. For **Push**, **Pull**, and **Slide**, count terrain movement costs against the listed forced movement distance.

**Difficult Terrain**, **Climb**, and **Jump** each cost **2"** of movement per **1"** moved. If more than one of these costs applies to the same **1"** of movement, apply only the single highest movement cost for that **1"** unless a rule says otherwise.

**Teleportation** ignores intervening terrain but applies destination terrain after placement.

# 6.10 Backgrounds

Choose one background or roll **1d20** on the **Random Background Table**.

## Random Background Table (d20)

| d20 | Background |
|---|---|
| 1 | Farmer |
| 2 | Nomad |
| 3 | Sailor |
| 4 | Soldier |
| 5 | Smuggler |
| 6 | Courier |
| 7 | Scout |
| 8 | Performer |
| 9 | Artisan |
| 10 | Scholar |
| 11 | Apprentice |
| 12 | Alchemist |
| 13 | Believer |
| 14 | Hermit |
| 15 | Cultist |
| 16 | Shepherd |
| 17 | Merchant |
| 18 | Noble |
| 19 | Pauper |
| 20 | Vagabond |

## Farmer

*A farmer grows up with callused hands, stubborn habits, and the certain knowledge that work hurts and stops for no one. Hard ground built them a thicker frame than most wandering blades will ever earn.*

**Bonus: +1 STR**
**Starting Coins and Items:** 1c, Sickle, Bandages
**Special Rule:** Gain **+3 Max HP**.

## Nomad

*A nomad crosses hard country under open skies, surviving where the roads fail and shelter is never promised. The land that grinds others down only taught them its lessons.*

**Bonus: +1 STR**
**Starting Coins and Items:** 1c, Scimitar
**Special Rule:** Once per round, when terrain, weather, or a scenario hazard would cause this Hero to suffer damage or HP loss, reduce that damage or HP loss by **1**.

## Sailor

*A sailor learns balance on wet planks and danger under bad skies, shaped by rope, spray, and labour that does not wait on the weather. They keep their feet and keep moving while steadier folk go down.*

**Bonus: +1 STR**
**Starting Coins and Items:** 1c, Rope, Short-sword, Buckler
**Special Rule:** Ignore additional movement costs and movement **Checks** caused by wind, rain, ice, shallow water, and **Slippery Terrain** caused by water, ice, or weather. Your **Checks** to resist forced movement caused by wind or water are rolled with **Advantage**.

## Soldier

*A soldier marched where they were told and fought when they were ordered, and learned that discipline keeps people alive longer than courage alone. War has settled into them now, and sits easy on the shoulders.*

**Bonus: +1 STR**
**Starting Coins and Items:** 1c, Spear
**Special Rule:** Your first melee attack each round deals an additional **1 damage of that attack's primary damage type**.

## Smuggler

*A smuggler lives by false bottoms, whispered routes, and the craft of keeping valuable things out of dangerous hands. Stealth is not a flourish to them. It is the trade that buys supper.*

**Bonus: +1 DEX**
**Starting Coins and Items:** 1c, Dagger, Lockpicks
**Special Rule:** While you are in **Cover**, your **Hide distance** is **0"**.

## 7.8 Melee Weapons

*Many of the arms below carry names from an older, wider world than the Bastions now remember: the long-bladed messer, the notched sword-breaker, the throwing cross, the bladed scourge, the weighted cord, and the hook-and-chain. They reach the Dying Lands as salvage, tribute, and trade goods, carried up the southern routes through Saltspire and bartered onward through Reedmarch. How a blade is named changes nothing about how it cuts. Each is listed here under the name the traders used.*

**Unarmed Combat** is a universal attack profile, not an item. A Hero may use it only while both hands are free. It cannot be bought, sold, carried, lost, disarmed, or enhanced unless a rule explicitly says otherwise.

Damage type abbreviations in weapon tables: **(B)** blunt, **(P)** piercing, **(S)** slashing, **(F)** fire, **(I)** ice, **(L)** lightning, **(N)** necrotic, **(H)** holy, **(Ar)** arcane, **(Po)** poison, **(Ps)** psychic.

| Weapon | Cost (c) | Hands | STR Req | DEX Req | Damage | Traits |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Unarmed Combat | 0 | 2 | - | - | 1 (B) | **Trip** |
| Club | 0 | 1 | - | - | 1d4 (B) | - |
| Mace | 2 | 1 | 2 | - | 1d6 (B) | **Parrying** |
| Morningstar | 6 | 1 | 2 | - | 1d8 (B) | **Deadly** |
| Flail | 10 | 1 | 3 | - | 1d8 (B) | **Sweep**, **Trip** |
| War Maul | 24 | 2 | 4 | - | 1d12 (B) | **Fatal**, **Heavy** |
| Greathammer | 30 | 2 | 5 | - | 1d12+1 (B) | **Fatal**, **Heavy** |
| Dagger | 1 | 1 | - | - | 1d4 (P) | **Agile**, **Finesse**, **Light** |
| Stiletto | 2 | 1 | 1 | 2 | 1d4 (P) | **Deadly**, **Finesse**, **Light** |
| Shortsword | 5 | 1 | 2 | 1 | 1d6 (S) | **Light**, **Parrying** |
| Rapier | 8 | 1 | - | 3 | 1d8 (P) | **Agile**, **Finesse**, **Parrying** |
| Estoc | 19 | 1/2 | 3 | 2 | 1d8/1d10 (P) | **Fatal**, **Finesse**, **Versatile** |
| Baselard | 6 | 1 | 2 | 2 | 1d6 (S) | **Agile**, **Light**, **Parrying** |
| Sabre | 8 | 1 | 2 | 4 | 1d8 (S) | **Agile**, **Finesse**, **Light**, **Parrying** |
| Scimitar | 7 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 1d8 (S) | **Agile**, **Finesse**, **Graze** |
| Longsword | 12 | 1/2 | 3 | - | 1d8/1d10 (S) | **Parrying**, **Versatile** |
| Bastard Sword | 30 | 1/2 | 4 | - | 1d10/1d12 (S) | **Parrying**, **Versatile** |
| Langes Messer | 19 | 1/2 | 3 | 2 | 1d8/1d10 (S) | **Deadly**, **Parrying**, **Versatile** |
| Great Falchion | 8 | 2 | 3 | 1 | 1d10 (S) | **Graze**, **Sweep** |
| Flamberge | 42 | 2 | 5 | - | 1d12+1 (S) | **Deadly**, **Graze**, **Heavy**, **Parrying** |
| Zweihander | 48 | 2 | 6 | 1 | 1d12+2 (S) | **Cleave**, **Fatal**, **Heavy** |
| Claymore | 24 | 2 | 5 | - | 1d12 (S) | **Cleave**, **Graze**, **Heavy** |
| Battleaxe | 18 | 1/2 | 3 | - | 1d8/1d10 (S) | **Cleave**, **Parrying**, **Versatile** |
| Greataxe | 36 | 2 | 4 | - | 1d12+1 (S) | **Cleave**, **Fatal**, **Heavy** |
| Handaxe | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1d6 (S) | **Light**, **Thrown** |
| Throwing Cross | 5 | 1 | - | 4 | 1d6 (S) | **Agile**, **Deadly**, **Thrown** |

**Description:** While using **Block**, attacks cannot deal **Critical Hit** bonus damage or trigger **Critical Hit** effects against you.

**14 Sacred Bulwark of Saints**
**Equipment Type** Hands **AD/AV** +6 **STR** 7 **DEX** - **INT** - **SPI** 4 **DEX Pen** -4 **Max Speed** 5" **Cost (c)** 122
**Description:** While using **Block**, you are **Resistant** to damage from attacks, Powers, and Special Abilities made by Undead, Fiends, and **Cursed** combatants. You have **Advantage** on **Checks** made to resist their Powers, Special Abilities, and negative conditions.

**15 Mantle of the Phoenix**
**Equipment Type** Back **AD/AV** +1 **STR** - **DEX** 7 **INT** - **SPI** 4 **DEX Pen** - **Max Speed** - **Cost (c)** 116
**Description:** Gain **+1 AV**. You are **Resistant** to **fire**. At the end of each round, restore 1 HP.

**16 Cloak of Infernal Embers**
**Equipment Type** Back **AD/AV** +1 **STR** - **DEX** 7 **INT** - **SPI** 4 **DEX Pen** - **Max Speed** - **Cost (c)** 118
**Description:** Gain **+1 AV**. After a non-**Total Miss** melee attack against you resolves, the attacker suffers **4 fire damage**.

**17 Frostcloak of Immortals**
**Equipment Type** Back **AD/AV** +1 **STR** - **DEX** 7 **INT** - **SPI** 4 **DEX Pen** - **Max Speed** - **Cost (c)** 118
**Description:** Gain **+1 AV**. After a non-**Total Miss** melee attack against you resolves, the attacker suffers **4 ice damage**.

**18 Mantle of the Stormlord**
**Equipment Type** Back **AD/AV** +1 **STR** - **DEX** 7 **INT** - **SPI** 4 **DEX Pen** - **Max Speed** - **Cost (c)** 120
**Description:** Gain **+1 AV**. After a non-**Total Miss** melee attack against you resolves, the attacker suffers **4 lightning damage**.

**19 Cloak of Divine Life**
**Equipment Type** Back **AD/AV** +1 **STR** - **DEX** 7 **INT** - **SPI** 4 **DEX Pen** - **Max Speed** - **Cost (c)** 120
**Description:** Gain **+1 AV**. At the end of each round, restore 2 HP.

**20 Cloak of Eternity**
**Equipment Type** Back **AD/AV** +1 **STR** - **DEX** 7 **INT** - **SPI** 4 **DEX Pen** - **Max Speed** - **Cost (c)** 124
**Description:** Gain **+1 AV** and **+4 Max HP**. At the end of each round, restore 1 HP.

## Tier 1 Special Items (APL 1–2)

**1 Witchglass Lenses**
**Equipment Type** Head **STR** - **DEX** 1 **INT** - **SPI** - **Cost (c)** 13
**Description:** Your ranged weapon attacks ignore **Cover** against targets within **8"**.

**2 Deadhand Gauntlets**
**Equipment Type** Arms **STR** 2 **DEX** - **INT** - **SPI** - **Cost (c)** 14
**Description:** When you take the **Trip** action, you may target a combatant up to **1 Sz** larger than you. When your **Push** succeeds, increase its distance by **1"**.

**3 Gravebell Gorget**
**Equipment Type** Neck **STR** - **DEX** - **INT** - **SPI** - **Cost (c)** 14
**Description:** The first time each round an enemy scores a **Critical Hit** against you, ignore the universal **Critical Hit** rider for that attack's primary damage type. Exploding bonus dice and other **Critical Hit** effects apply normally.

**4 Grave-Step Anklets**
**Equipment Type** Feet **STR** - **DEX** 2 **INT** - **SPI** - **Cost (c)** 15
**Description:** Once during each of your activations, immediately after you resolve a melee weapon attack, you may **Shift 1"**.

**5 Cinder-Nail Clasp**
**Equipment Type** Back **STR** - **DEX** - **INT** - **SPI** - **Cost (c)** 15
**Description:** Once per round, when a weapon attack you make scores a **Critical Hit** and damages an enemy, that enemy gains **Burning**.

**6 Frost Bailiff's Signet**
**Equipment Type** Ring **STR** - **DEX** - **INT** - **SPI** - **Cost (c)** 15
**Description:** Once per round, when a weapon attack you make damages an enemy, you may **Push** or **Pull** that enemy **1"**.

**7 Chime of the Quiet Hour**
**Equipment Type** Hands **STR** - **DEX** - **INT** - **SPI** 2 **Cost (c)** 16
**Description:** **[1 AP]:** While held, each enemy within **4"** must pass a **SPI Check**. **Failure:** That enemy gains **Silenced**.

## Entry Structure

Each Monster entry is laid out in the order the Monster acts, so it can be read from top to bottom during play:

1. **Name and Role.** The Monster's name, with their battlefield Role in brackets.
2. **Description.** A short passage of lore and physical description, set in italics.
3. **Stat Line.** The table of HP, AV, SPD, LVL, CV, and Sz described above.
4. **AI Steps.** If the Monster has them, their numbered AI Steps appear here. When the Monster activates, they follow the Monster AI rules and attempt each AI Step in order. A step marked (on d6 N+) is attempted only if a d6 rolled for it shows N or higher.
5. **Attacks.** The Monster's attacks. If they have the Multi-Attack ability, that ability is listed first, since it governs how the attacks below it are made.
6. **Special Abilities.** The Monster's remaining abilities. Movement abilities, such as **Fly** or **Climb**, are always listed first.

Many Monsters share common abilities. A stat block may print their full rules or list them by name; **9.6 Universal Special Abilities** is authoritative.

## Greenmark Bestiary

### Giant Tarantula [Skirmisher]

*A hand-span of bristled legs around a body the size of a war helm, the giant tarantula stalks the Greenmark's leaf litter on stilted, deliberate steps. Its fangs weep a venom that turns a victim's muscles to wet rope. It spins no snares, preferring to run prey down and pin it where it falls. Foragers keep one eye on the canopy, because the largest specimens hunt from above and drop.*

| HP | AV | SPD | LVL | CV | Sz |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 9 | 0 | 6" | 1 | 1c | S |

**Attacks**

- **Bite:** 1d6 + 2 piercing damage.

**Special Abilities**

- **Small.**
- **Beast.**
- **Wallcrawler:** This Monster's listed **Speed** applies equally to vertical surfaces. They may move along walls and ceilings without spending additional movement for **Climb** and without making **STR Checks** to **Climb**. They cannot be knocked **Prone** while clinging to a vertical or overhanging surface.
- **Venom:** When this Monster's melee attack damages a target, that target must pass a **STR Check** or become **Poisoned [d4]**.
- **Standing Leap (6").**
- **Tremorsense (9").**

### Scenario 2: The Whispering Grove

*The grove is older than Greythorn and older than the western forest road that skirts it. The standing stones hum when no wind passes, and pale lights move between them on moonless nights. Greythorn's farmers leave bread there and do not look back. Scholars call it a site of power. The Council of Captains calls it part of the tithe, and pays it without complaint.*

**Primary Objective:** Be the party that has successfully activated the most Standing Stones by the end of Round 7.

**Final Random Monster Groups:** Determine using **10.6.4**.

**Awake Groups:** Random Monster Groups begin **Resting** unless a listed setup rule says otherwise. Scenario-specific Monsters use their listed state.

**Minion Swarm:** No.

**Objective Scaling:** Apply **10.6.9** to the Standing Stones. A majority is more than half the number placed.

**Level Scaling:** Use the Scenario APL for every APL-based Monster, hazard, objective, reward, and damage value in this scenario.

**Solo/Co-op Objective:** Activate a majority of the Standing Stones placed after scaling, then extract at least 1 Hero through any battlefield edge.

**Pressure Clock:** Use **Swarm** from **10.5.7**.

**Battlefield and Terrain (36"×36"):** Place 3–5 Tree area terrain pieces and 6–7 Undergrowth patches around the battlefield edges, leaving a Central Clearing (about 12–15" diameter) at the battlefield's centre. Within the Clearing, place 3 **Standing Stone** markers (1"×1") in a rough triangle, each 6–8" apart.

**Objective Placement:** The 3 Standing Stones are the Primary Objectives. Place 2 Treasure Chests (**1 Treasure roll with Disadvantage** each) within dense forest sections near different battlefield edges, at least 8" from any Stone.

#### Scenario-Specific Monster: Antlered Warden

*Not Old Wode themselves. Old Wode does not stir for small intrusions. The Antlered Warden is the agreement's enforcement arm: a figure woven from the grove's oldest growth, robed in bark and grey moss, with antlers that have more branches than any natural animal. It does not speak. It does not negotiate. It maintains the terms.*

| | |
|---|---|
| **HP** | (5 × Party Size × (2 + (1 × APL))) / 8 |
| **AV** | 1 + (APL/3, rounded down) |
| **SPD** | 6" (ignores forest **Difficult Terrain**) |
| **LVL** | APL (min 2, max 5) |
| **CV** | (2 + (4 × APL)) Coins |
| **Sz** | L |

**AI Steps**

**Target Priority:** Prioritize the valid Hero who most recently activated or attempted to activate a Standing Stone. Otherwise, use the normal Monster target priorities.

1. **Entangling Roots:** If the **Primary Target** is within **8"** and is not **Immobilized**, that enemy must pass a **DEX Check** or become **Immobilized**. Then end this activation.

**Attacks**

- **Thorny Vine Lash: Reach**, 1d6 + APL/2 slashing damage.
- **Mystic Bolt:** 1d4 + APL psychic damage, **Ranged 10"**.

**Special Abilities**

- **Fey Resistance:** This Monster is **Resistant** to **arcane** damage, and is **Immune** to **Frightened** and **Sleeping**.

**Boss Deployment:** Not yet placed at setup. When a Hero first Interacts with a Standing Stone, place the Antlered Warden adjacent to that Stone. The Antlered Warden is **Awake** when placed.

**Random Monster Setup:**

- **Group 1:** Roll once on the Greenmark Random Monster Table. Place within **3"** of one outer Standing Stone. **Resting**.
- **Group 2:** Roll once on the Greenmark Random Monster Table. Place inside the Central Clearing, **4"** from its edge. **Resting**.
- **Group 3:** Roll once on the Greenmark Random Monster Table. Place within **3"** of one Treasure Chest. **Resting**.

**Party Deployment:** Parties make a Setup Roll-off. The winner chooses an 8"×8" corner zone. The other party deploys in the diagonally opposite corner.

isfies only the contract's Hero-extraction requirement; that Hero does not leave the battlefield and is not extracted for any other rule. After applying this exception, reroll a term whose required target, object, action, or extraction cannot legally occur in the generated adventure. If no legal term exists after checking all 3 terms, cancel the contract and refund its **1 TAP** at the start of the next Town Phase.

If the party completes the contract and at least **1** Hero extracts, gain **5c × APL** during Aftermath, using the party's APL at the start of that adventure. If the party does not complete the contract, gain nothing. A side contract never changes the scenario's victory conditions, never counts as a Secondary Objective, and cannot be accepted for the **Triumph Finale**.

- **Map Room [1 TAP]:** Study the next battlefield's known approaches. In competitive play, your party automatically wins the Setup Roll-off in the next adventure. In solo or cooperative play, after generating the next adventure's Core Scenario, roll one additional Core Scenario from the same Climate and choose which of the two scenarios to play. If the next adventure is fixed by a scenario, campaign rule, or Triumph Objective, you instead gain **Advantage** on the first **Setup Roll-off**, search, or scenario **Interact Check** made by your party during that adventure.

## 11.2.5 Hirelings

During the **Town Phase**, your party may recruit persistent **Hirelings** into its **Stronghold** roster. A Hireling remains on that roster until they are slain, dismissed during a **Town Phase**, or removed by a specific rule.

Hirelings are purchased with **Treasury** funds during the **Town Phase**. Recruiting a Hireling costs **1 TAP** and their listed coin cost.

Hirelings require no recurring upkeep once recruited. A party's **Stronghold** roster may contain no more than **8 Hirelings** total, including Animal Companions. A Hireling may be dismissed for no TAP cost during the Town Phase; a dismissed Hireling is removed permanently and grants no refund.

### Active Hirelings and Summon Limits

At the start of each adventure, after choosing the Heroes who will take part in that adventure, choose which Hirelings from your **Stronghold** roster will deploy with that party.

The maximum number of active Hirelings for that adventure is determined by the number of Heroes in that party at the start of the adventure.

| Heroes in the Party | Maximum Active Hirelings | Per-Hero Control Limit |
|---:|---:|---:|
| **4** | **4** | **1** per Hero |
| **3** | **3** | **1** per Hero |
| **2** | **4** | **2** per Hero |
| **1** | **3** | **3** for that Hero |

These limits are checked only when the adventure begins. They do not recalculate later in that adventure if one or more Heroes are removed from play.

When you choose active Hirelings for an adventure, assign each active Hireling to a specific Hero in that party. That assignment is locked for the duration of the adventure.

A Hireling may only be assigned to a Hero whose printed **SPI** is equal to or greater than that Hireling's listed **Min SPI** value.

Use the Hero's printed **SPI** on their Hero sheet. Temporary in-adventure modifiers do not change which Hirelings that Hero may control.

Hirelings, including Animal Companions, do not count against the party-wide limit of **2** active allied Summons. See **2.5.1 Summon Limits**.

### Specialist Hireling Roster

These are trained mortal retainers recruited into the party's **Stronghold** roster.

**Porter**

**Min SPI** 2 **Cost** 12c **SPD** 6" **Sz** M **HP** 6 **AV** 0
**Attack** None

**Special Abilities:** Cannot attack. May use **Interact** to pick up, carry, transfer, drop, and extract one treasure chest, relic, or other bulky objective as though they were a **Hero**. This permission does not allow them to control or score any other objective. **Drag [1 AP]:** Move one adjacent **Knocked Out** Hero **2"**.

## C.5 Reactions Summary

A **Reaction** is an action taken when a rule's stated trigger occurs, usually outside the reacting combatant's activation. A combatant may take a **Reaction** during their own activation if its trigger occurs then. Taking a **Reaction** does not begin or end an activation. To take a **Reaction**, a combatant must have enough unspent AP to pay their cost. **Heroes** and **Hirelings** may use **Reactions** unless a rule says otherwise. Allied **Summons** may use **Reactions** only if a rule explicitly grants that **Summon Reactions**. **Monsters** do not take **Reactions** unless a rule explicitly allows them. A combatant may take multiple **Reactions** in the same round if they have enough unspent AP and a legal trigger, but may take only one **Reaction** in response to the same action or effect. For each affected combatant, only 1 Reaction may be declared by that combatant or on their behalf to modify how the source resolves against them; if 2 or more would do so, the affected combatant's controller chooses which one is declared, and the others spend no costs. A Reaction used by the source's controller to modify the source's own roll does not count against an affected combatant's limit. A Reaction resolves immediately when declared unless its rule or a resolution sequence assigns a later timing. A Reaction that grants a separate action still uses the reacting combatant's one-Reaction limit, but does not prevent a different combatant from reacting unless both Reactions would modify the source against the same affected combatant. If no rule grants an allied **Summon Reactions**, their unspent AP cannot be spent on **Reactions** and is discarded at the end of the round.

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*Main entries follow the terms of C.11 Glossary of Terms and Conditions. Locators point to the glossary entry, the sections it cites, and sections that define or apply the term.*


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